under Govt, but I tell him this is impossible at least until I am in some way quit of my debts. I have a great respect for him, his noble conduct about Stoddard and Conolly is beyond all praise, but I am not nearly so with him as he wishes; the other day he asked me whether I was angry at any thing he had said or done, because I had not seen him for something more than twenty four hours, he made me read the prayers for the sick for him, and wanted me to sleep constantly in his room, which last I refused to do. He was not so unwell as to require it and I did not think I was called upon to sleep in a sick room unless it was absolutely necessary.

The christening of Mr Bonham's child was one of the merryest parties I have seen. The ceremony was performed about 12 o'clock and afterwards we had a champaigne breakfast or dinner whichever you like to call it. The band of one of the regiments was there and they play waltzes and mazurkas in great style. After breakfast the whole party began dancing like mad — all men — The Russian Consul General danced a minuet with an old Greek merchant who having passed his youth in Italy, danced very well, and his wearing a grizly beard about four inches long added to the grotesqueness of his appearance. One of the party put on some of Dr Wolff's Bokhara dresses, and danced in them, they consisted of embroidered silk cloaks and a high black lamb's skin cap. It is but fair to confess that your dutiful son was dancing about just as mad as any one. Even after we were tired with dancing and some of the party sat down to whist, between the deals a whist player would jump up and seizing a partner would go spinning around the room amongst chairs tables etc in a waltz, or dashing about at a gallop. Three Koords one of them my servant danced their quaint national dance before the window. A cask of spirits something like whiskey was broached for the band and any one else who liked to drink it, and this with cold beef and other auxiliaries made the people outside just as merry as those in the drawing room.

You must excuse the slovenly appearance of a great part of this letter; whilst I have been writing a great part of it I have had the room full of people and I have been dictating Persian letters and accounts about the business of the villages. In Persia a man gets the habit of working amid noise and confusion. I knew a man when he had hard work to do, who used to send for a fiddler, singer and tambourin player and amidst the noise they made he worked the best.

I have not yet been able to come to any arrangement with my creditors. The great thing that prevents it is that the govt claim from me the money Charles owes for the muskets. Latterly a firman has been sent here ordering that one man should be appointed on the part of the govt one on the part of my creditors and one on my part these three to meet and settle the matter. I do not think that any thing will come of it, at least I am affraid not. Before I can even think of returning to England something must be done about this business.

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